

AtliQ Sales & CRM Assistant

A capstone project brief

Build an AI-powered system that gives a founder-led sales team a working memory, and take it end to end, from discovering the real problem to demoing your prototype to stakeholders.

Field	Detail
Project	Capstone 1: AtliQ Sales & CRM Assistant
Domain	B2B software services / founder-led sales
What you'll build	An AI system that solves the pain point of a founder-led sales team
Data provided	A synthetic dataset (CRM export, email threads, meeting notes), see below
You will produce	7 deliverables: user research, opportunity map, PRD, cost estimation, working prototype, presentation, demo video

What This Capstone Is Really Testing

Not just whether you can build an AI app, but whether you can think like an AI PM: start from the real problem, decide where AI genuinely helps, spec it clearly, build a grounded and safe prototype, and tell the story to stakeholders. The build is one step of seven.

1. The Scenario

AtliQ Technologies is a software services company that builds custom software, data platforms, and AI solutions for clients around the world. Sales is founder-led: the two founders and the CEO close most deals themselves, supported by just one dedicated salesperson, and all of them juggle selling with running the company's day-to-day operations.

The leads are there; the system around them isn't. Opportunities arrive from every direction (referrals, LinkedIn, conferences, existing clients), often while the founders are between meetings or on the road, and many never make it into the CRM at all. The ones that do are thin: a name and a company, entered days later, with the context of the conversation already fading.

A CRM is not just a place to put records, it should capture the details and the progress of every relationship. Today the signals that matter live everywhere except the CRM: an email where a client casually mentions a second problem AtliQ could solve, a lost deal that said "check back in Q4", a proposal sitting unanswered for three weeks. So cross-sells go unnoticed, follow-ups slip, and revisits never happen. Nobody is careless; there

is simply no time between selling and operating to keep the system honest. Revenue leaks not from a lack of leads, but from a lack of memory.

2. The Dataset You Receive

You are given a fully synthetic dataset (inspired by AtliQ's real situation, no real client or deal data). Treat "today" as 10 July 2026 when reading dates. A data dictionary (README) is included, read it first.

Source	File	What it is
CRM Export	crm_export.csv	40 leads and accounts exactly as they exist in the CRM today: incomplete, stale, and occasionally duplicated
Email Threads	emails/ (34 files)	Client and prospect conversations; some contradict the CRM, some involve leads the CRM has never heard of
Meeting Notes	meeting_notes/ (16 files)	Call and meeting summaries of very uneven quality, including an internal pipeline review worth reading closely
Data Dictionary	README.md	Explains every file and column, read it first

3. What You Will Deliver

Take the project through seven stages. Each stage produces one deliverable you submit.

Step 1: Problem Discovery and User Research

- Step into the shoes of AtliQ's founder-sellers. Work through the persona, empathy map, and 5-Whys to get from the surface complaint down to the real root cause.
- Complete the provided activity worksheet.

Deliverable: Filled "2 Template Problem Discovery and User Research.xlsx" (persona, empathy map, 5 Whys, root-cause problem statement, proposed solution).

Step 2: AI Opportunity Mapping

- Break the founder's sales workflow into stages and map where AI could help. Score the opportunities (impact vs feasibility), decide what the solution should and should NOT do, and map each chosen feature to an AI capability and its guardrails.
- Do this on a Miro board: no worksheet is provided for this step, you build the board yourself.

Deliverable: A Miro board (share the link or export a PDF/image).

Step 3: AI PRD

- Write an AI PRD for the solution you chose, using Template PRD.docx.
- Define your North Star metric and the supporting metrics that will tell you whether the solution works. Your PRD must include a dedicated North Star and Metrics section.

Deliverable: An AI PRD document (Word) with a North Star and Metrics section.

Step 4: Cost Estimation

- Before you build anything, estimate what your solution will cost to run: which model(s) you plan to use, expected token usage per interaction, expected volumes, and any infrastructure. Cost is a product decision, not an afterthought, so let it shape your scope.
- Use the provided Cost Estimation.xlsx.

Deliverable: A filled Cost Estimation.xlsx.

Step 5: Build the Prototype (Vibe Code)

- Build a working AI prototype of the solution you specified in your PRD. It must work over the provided dataset (extend it if you need to), produce grounded and trustworthy outputs, and respect the guardrails you defined in Step 2. The architecture and approach are your call, that is the PM's job.
- Use the vibe-coding skills from the course.
- Deploy the solution to cloud using Vercel (free tier) etc.

Deliverable: Working code plus a short README explaining how to run it.

Step 6: Presentation

- Create a slide deck that tells the whole story: the problem and your discovery insights, the opportunity you chose, the solution and a walkthrough, your success metrics, and the risks and guardrails.

Deliverable: A presentation file (.pptx or PDF).

Step 7: Stakeholder Demo Video

- Record a short video (about 5 minutes) demonstrating your prototype as if you are presenting to AtliQ's stakeholders (the founders and the CEO). Show the live prototype handling real scenarios from the dataset, explain how it stays grounded and safe, and make the business case.
- Speak to the impact, not just the features: you are a PM pitching, not an engineer demoing.

Deliverable: A recorded demo video (share the link).

4. Submission Checklist

#	Deliverable	Format
1	Completed user research worksheet	Excel (.xlsx)
2	AI opportunity map	Miro board link / export
3	AI PRD	Word / PDF
4	Cost estimation	Excel (.xlsx)
5	Working AI prototype	Code + README
6	Presentation	PPTX / PDF
7	Stakeholder demo video	Video link (~5 min)

How You'll Be Assessed

- Problem clarity: did you find the real problem?
- AI fit: is AI the right call, and did you scope it well?
- PRD quality.
- A grounded, safe, working prototype.
- A demo that a real stakeholder would find convincing.

The strongest submissions treat all seven pieces as one coherent story.